PITCH DECK | PERPLEXITY DEAL DESK LEAD

Every nonstandard quote at a fast-growing AI company needs one person who can structure the deal, defend the number, and keep pace with how fast the field moves. I have already built that exact system, twice.

Deal-desk tooling, margin recovery and quote-to-order ownership from someone who builds this exact product on the side.

- **$700K+** margin recovered in 2 quarters, Sensata Bleeders and Leakers program
- **53% to 61%** distributor margin lift via repricing logic that stuck
- **PriceKeel** - founder of a discount-guardrail engine and Finance audit trail
- **AP26 revenue models** and multimillion-dollar customer quotes closed with senior executives
- **AI agents built on Claude** automating recurring deal and margin review

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WHY THIS DECK EXISTS

The problem is not that Perplexity lacks a pricing policy. It is that a Deal Desk function built from zero has to keep pace with how fast an AI-native company closes deals, without becoming the thing Sales routes around.

What building a Deal Desk from zero actually requires

An approval framework and quote-to-order workflow that Sales, Finance and Legal all trust enough to move fast on, not a policy document nobody opens before a live call.

A way to model each deal's economics, discounts, commitments and payment terms, that an account executive can get a workable alternative from in minutes, not a flat yes or no after escalation.

Business requirements and acceptance criteria for the quote-to-order system itself, with someone willing to run business acceptance testing and sign off, not just configure a tool someone else specced.

What I have already run

At **PriceKeel**, I built the discount-guardrail engine and Finance audit trail from zero, the exact approval-framework-plus-audit-trail this seat stands up for Perplexity.

At **Sensata**, I recovered $700K+ in margin in 2 quarters negotiating nonstandard terms deal by deal, and closed AP26 revenue models and multimillion-dollar customer quotes directly with senior executives.

I own my own **CRM, CPQ, forecast and pipeline reviews** and quote-to-order requirements at PriceKeel instead of inheriting someone else's stack, the same build-from-zero mandate this role carries.

The through-line: every Deal Desk system I have touched started with a nonstandard request that needed a fast, defensible call, and ended with a rule Legal, Finance and Sales could all act on without waiting on me.

THE MANDATE, MAPPED

What the posting asks for, and where the proof already sits.

What the role covers

> *"Own Deal Desk end to end and build the team as we grow... bring Sales, Finance, and Legal together to resolve issues quickly."*

> *"Structure deals and balance trade-offs... offering practical alternatives rather than a simple yes or no."*

> *"Own quote-to-order requirements and delivery... owning business acceptance testing and sign-off."*

My proof

Build the function, bring Sales/Finance/Legal together: built PriceKeel's guardrail engine and quote-to-order logic from zero, selling that exact tooling to RevOps, Sales leadership and Finance.

Structure deals and balance trade-offs: recovered $700K+ in margin in 2 quarters at Sensata by deciding, deal by deal, where to hold firm and where to bend against competitive gaps and customer willingness to pay.

Own quote-to-order requirements and acceptance: defines the business requirements and acceptance criteria behind PriceKeel's own CRM, CPQ and deal-approval workflow, holding its systems accountable for delivery.

Build and hire the team: hired and managed an 8-person team at Pixis and closed AP26 revenue models and multimillion-dollar customer quotes with senior Sensata executives.

THE SENSATA PROOF, IN DEPTH

Bleeders and Leakers: find the margin leak, close it, make it hold.

Built as a BU-wide Power BI system covering 1,200 pricing opportunities against a $627M target across 3 regions, 4 product families and 20 product lines, with pipeline funnel, win rate and stage distribution by product line, so leadership could prioritize instead of chasing anecdotes.

$433M

Margin Shortfall Surfaced

Ranked every pricing opportunity by competitive gap and customer willingness to pay, the same triage an approval framework needs to decide which deals escalate.

$700K+

Margin Recovered in 2 Quarters

Closed through deal-by-deal negotiation on nonstandard terms, not an across-the-board policy change.

53% to 61%

Distributor Margin Lift

Repriced the channel logic itself, so the gain held past the first quarter instead of drifting back under renewal pressure.

The same BU also ran AP26 revenue models and multimillion-dollar customer quotes alongside senior executives on its highest-value accounts. The common thread: every fix was deal-specific, and every fix was measured after it shipped, not left as a policy memo.

FIRST 30 DAYS

What the first month building Perplexity's Deal Desk from zero looks like.

WEEK 1

Map every nonstandard request from last quarter

Pull every discount exception, custom term and escalation AEs requested last quarter, sit with Sales, Finance and Legal to find exactly where today's process creates friction before writing a single rule.

Why first: the same move that started the Bleeders and Leakers program at Sensata, find the leak before naming the fix.

WEEK 2-3

Ship the first approval framework and playbook

Build the first approval framework and discount guardrail for the highest-volume deal type, pressure-test it live with an AE under quarter-end pressure, and ship it as a rule Legal and Finance can both act on without waiting on a person.

Why now: the same deal-by-deal modeling discipline that made the 53% to 61% distributor gain stick instead of drift back.

WEEK 4

Define acceptance criteria, automate the easy call

Write the business requirements and acceptance criteria for the first quote-to-order fix, hold Systems accountable for shipping it, and let the CPQ enforce the rule on its own so only genuine exceptions reach a human.

Why this fast: the same AI-agent habit that keeps my own recurring reporting moving at Applied Materials today, not a plan for someday.

CLOSE

You are hiring someone to build Perplexity's Deal Desk from zero and own deal velocity, terms discipline and approval frameworks while hiring the team behind it. I have already built that system twice, with a number on it each time.

The margin half: **$700K+ recovered in 2 quarters** and distributor margins lifted **from 53% to 61%** at Sensata, closed through deal-by-deal negotiation rather than a policy memo, plus AP26 revenue models and multimillion-dollar customer quotes closed with senior executives.

The build half: **PriceKeel's guardrail engine and audit trail**, built from zero so Finance and Legal can act on every call, owning my own CRM, CPQ and quote-to-order requirements end to end. At Applied Materials I automate my own recurring pricing analysis with AI agents built on Claude instead of rebuilding the same report every cycle.

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